MICRO MINIATURE CATTLE BREEDING PROGRAM:

Artificial Insemination & Embryo Transfer Program



Artificial Insemination (AI) and Embryo Transfer (ET) are advanced, ethical breeding methods used by **leading registered miniature Highland programs** to preserve and **improve rare bloodlines**.

AI allows breeders to **inseminate elite cows with carefully selected semen from proven miniature Highland bulls**, ensuring precision in pairing and the introduction of **top-tier micro/mini cow genetics.**

Pictured: *Howe Ranch*'s exceptional micro mini calves – Pippi and Marvin of *Wildhaven Cattle Co.*'s & *Webb Cattle Co.*'s Embryo Transfer Programs

Step	What Happens
Elite Donor Cow Selected	Only cows with exceptional structure, rare bloodlines, and true miniature traits are chosen.
Superovulation & AI	The donor receives carefully measured hormones and is bred using top miniature Highland bull genetics.
Embryo Collection ("Flush")	Embryos are collected and graded in a specialized reproductive facility.
Embryo Transfer to Recipients	Healthy recipient cows — often larger-bodied for safe calving — carry the embryo to term.
Resulting Calf	The calf carries 100% of the genetics of the donor and bull, not the recipient

By the time an ET mini-Highland calf hits the ground, total breeding investment commonly ranges between $6,000 – $12,000 per calf — before raising, training, or socialization (add 5 x that investment by 12 months).

1 Why ET-Bred Micro Mini Haighlands Carry Highler Value

- ✅ Only the top 1–2% of genetics are eligible for ET programs
- ✅ Each embryo can cost $3,500–$7,000 before the calf is even conceived
- ✅ Recipient care, vet work, hormone protocols, and specialist fees add to total cost
- ✅ Not every embryo survives or results in a live calf — making each successful ET calf rare
- ✅ These programs produce for correctness, temperament, and long-term soundness — not volume

2 How does it work?

Investment Perspective

Stage	Common Cost Range
Embryo purchase (per embryo)	$3,500 – $7,000
Recipient synchronization & transfer	$1,500 – $3,000
Recipient care through birth	$1,000+

Loss rate compensation / non-success cycles built into overall pricing

3 Why This Matters

o These calves are not mass-produced or auction-line stock.

o Each one represents bloodline preservation, ethical breeding, hands-on imprinting, and early socialization — which directly affects temperament, therapy suitability, and long-term soundness.

o When you meet one of our calves, you're meeting the result of a highly selective and intentional breeding journey.

Suggested Resource: International Miniature Cattle Breeder's Registry: https://minicattle.com/